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War and Literature I

- SEMINARS, WORKSHOPS AND CONFERENCES
- HEALTHY COMPETETIONS
- EXPLOSION OF STUDENT'S INNER HIDDEN TALENTS

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From the Committee

War was the first subject of literature; at times, war has been its only subject. In this volume, the contributors reflect on the uneasy yet symbiotic relations of war and writing, from medieval to modern literature. War writing emerges in multiple forms, celebratory and critical, awed and disgusted; the rhetoric of inexpressibility fights its own battle with the urgent necessity of representation, record and recognition. This is shown to be true even to the present day: whether mimetic or metaphorical, literature that concerns itself overtly or covertly with the real pressures of war continues to speak to issues of pressing significance, and to provide some clues to the intricate entwinement of war with contemporary life. Particular topics addressed include writings of and about the crusades and battles during the hundred years war; Shakespeare's "casus belly"; Auden's "journal of an airman"; and war and peace.

WAR IN LITERATURE

Literature is all about depicting life that includes emotions, experience, situations, feeling, and more to, anything added to life. Literature in World War I is generally thought to include poems, novels and drama; diaries, letters, and memoirs are often included in this category as well. "In broadly defining the genre of war writing, The Literature of War considers texts treating the diverse impacts of war on those who experience it, whether as soldiers or civilians, and examines the ways in which war is transformed through writing." Any war could eventually ends up with disaster.

War is a state of armed conflict between different countries or different groups within a country. War and Its Influence on Literature is defined as an act of invasion of nations to their opponents with the use of armed forces and other acts of combat. It is an act of bravery and heroism of citizens who have a sincere and deep yearning to serve his or her country.

Disaster is a sudden accident or a natural catastrophe that causes great damage or loss of life. In literature disaster is stunned by the tragedy of so many deaths or any literary composition, as a novel, dealing with a somber theme carried to a tragic or disastrous conclusion. It also includes the tragic or mournful or calamitous element of drama, of literature generally, or of life.

The Literature of War considers texts treating the diverse impacts of war on those who experience it, whether as soldiers or civilians, and examines the ways in which war is transformed through writing. There is something counterintuitive about "the literature of war." How can war, a phenomenon of destruction, give rise to literature, an act of creation? What sort of fiction, poetry, or drama might thrive on mass death, injury, and loss, other than the voyeuristic, the exploitative, or the simply sadistic? This is because, literature is all about depicting life and it includes everything that is happening or even fascinations that desires to happen! Literature is a wide view of emotions.

War literature does all of these things. It also warns against pursuing armed conflict, exposes its atrocities, and argues for peace. It records the acts of war with as much accuracy as possible, and it memorializes the dead. It is voyeuristic, exploitative, and sadistic; it is also tender, selfless, and comforting. It is gleeful and angry; inflammatory and cathartic; propagandist, passionate,

and clinical. It is funny and sad. The literature of war is a literature of paradoxes, the greatest of which is the fact that it comments continuously on its own failure. War writers often lament their incapacity to describe the realities of armed combat, the inexpressible nature of the subject matter, the inadequacy of language, and the inability of their audiences to understand.

The English novelist Henry Green, sensing that the Second World War was breaking up everything that he knew and relied on, nonetheless remarked, “these times are an absolute gift to the writer.” Created from destruction, the literature of war is writing stretched to its limits, demanding extraordinary resourcefulness from those who seek to produce it. Its readers also have significant responsibilities. Understanding how and why truths and lies about war are conveyed, perceiving the status of those who convey them, and appreciating the surrounding ethical issues are nothing less than necessary acts of global citizenship.

Although the canon continues to be challenged, the texts most frequently taught in schools and universities are lyrics by ‘Siegfried Sassoon’ and ‘Wilfred Owen’; poems by ‘Ivor Gurney’, ‘Edward Thomas’, ‘Charles Sorley’, ‘David Jones’ and ‘Isaac Rosenberg’ are also widely anthologized. Many of the works during and about the war were written by men, because of the war's intense demand on the young men of that generation; however, a number of women (especially in the British tradition) created literature about the war, often observing the effects of the war on soldiers, and the domestic spaces. Therefore, we can see that both men and women have given equal importance in war on literature. The disaster is equally effected by both men and women, mainly in loss of life and life stocks.

Novels concerning the First World War continued to appear in the latter half of the 20th century albeit less frequently. The novel ‘Covenant With Death’ (1961) by John Harris portrays a Sheffield Pals Battalion on the first day of the Battle of the Somme in 1916 and Christopher Hitchens later referred to it as a 'neglected masterpiece'. In the mid-1960s there was a resurgence of fiction depicting the aerial campaigns of the Great War, including ‘The Blue Max’ (1964) by Jack D Hunter, which became a major film in 1966 along with ‘A Killing for the Hawks’ (1966) by Frederick E Smith and ‘In the Company of Eagles’ (1966) by Ernest K Gann.

It can be concluded that war or disaster in literature is therefore, relevant in all times. “War & peace” is a common aspect since the recognition of mankind. Wherever there is a conflict, chances of war evokes and eventually ends up in fighting for peace that results in disaster. The whole process goes through various efforts, sacrifices, loss to earn enough peace in the land of culture and manliness. These struggles of life are depicted by the writers and included in literature as a genre itself

because, these became repeating and consistent. Thus war and disaster had a prominent place in literature since World War I. Those literary forms show in prose, drama and poems portraits the life in war, refugee, homeless culture, struggles, comrades life, and so on. This literature form becomes prominent as it keeps a record of culture of war entirely from the ancient times to present.

-by Athira

I M.A

Twilight's Touch

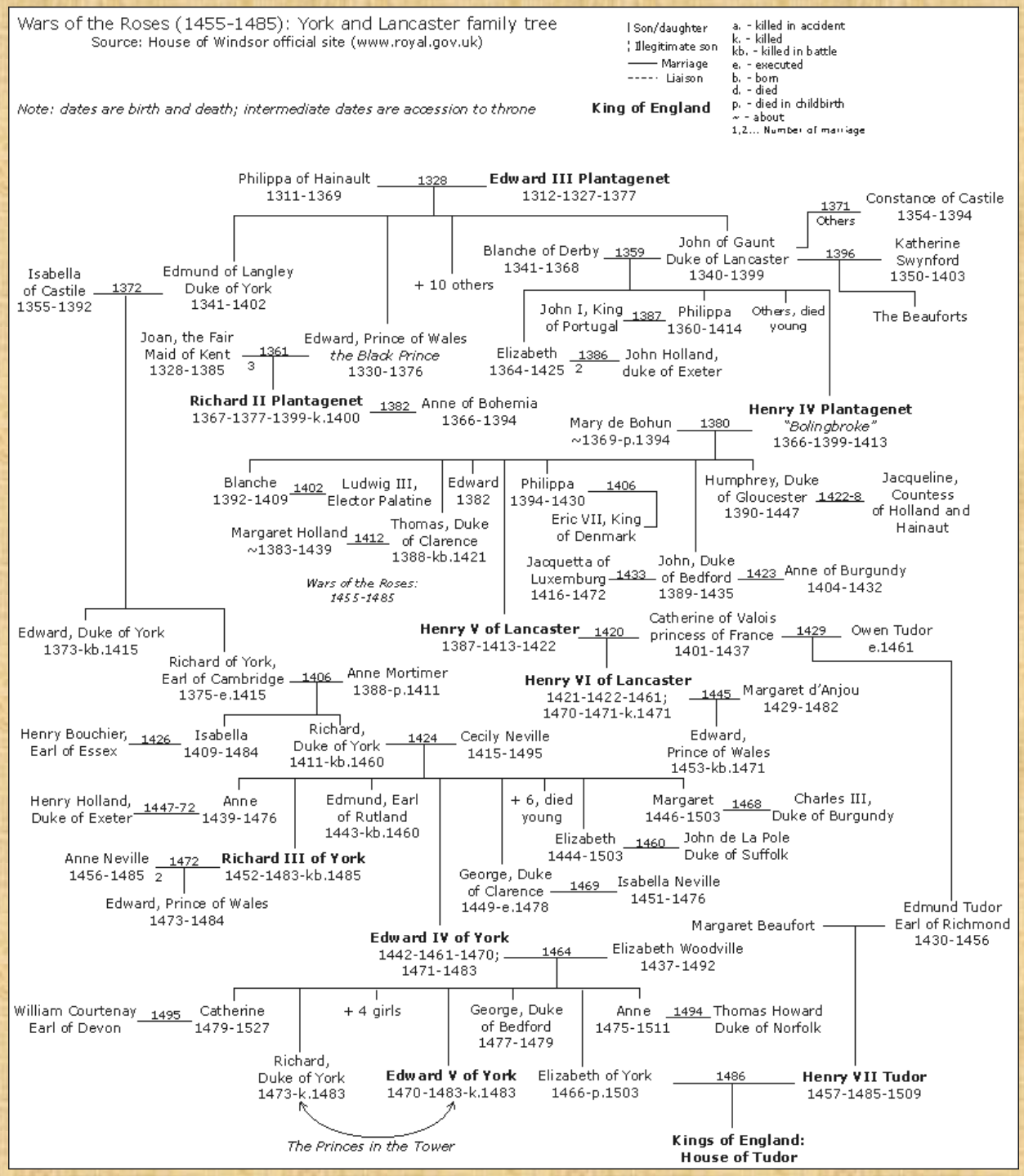
The busy sun gathering
Its glossy rays and
Strolled towards
Horizon;

The creamy orange
Prefaces the twilight;
Embarkation of sun
Arouses the dozed off
Evening dew which emerged fearlessly
And hugged the
Mango-groove tenderly
That blinded the woods
Completely…..

The gust carried the dangling
Flowers as a group of butterflies
On hunt….
Chirping of poky birds and cooing
Of cuckoo unveiled the aroma of dusk
The twilight lady compassionately hugs
Earth's children with her brawny arms
And it slouched towards west.
An unheard lullaby echoed the
Whole universe…..

R. Mangalaeswari, Ph.D Scholar

Wars of the Roses:



The Wars of the Roses were a series of wars for control of the throne of England fought between supporters of two rival branches of the royal House of Plantagenet: the House of Lancaster (associated with a red rose), and the House of York (whose symbol was a white rose). The conflict lasted through many sporadic episodes between 1455 and 1487; however, there was fighting before and after this period between the houses. The power

struggle ignited around social and financial troubles following the Hundred Years' War, combined with the mental infirmity and weak rule of Henry VI which revived interest in Richard, Duke of York's claim to the throne.

With the Duke of York's passing, the claim transferred to his heir, Edward, who later became the first Yorkist king of England, as Edward IV. Soon after Edward IV's death, the throne passed to his younger brother, Richard III, after the disappearances of Edward's sons, Edward V and Richard of Shrewsbury, Duke of York, within the confines of the Tower of London.

The final victory went to a claimant of the Lancastrian party, Henry Tudor, Earl of Richmond, who defeated the last Yorkist king, Richard III, at the Battle of Bosworth Field. After assuming the throne as Henry VII, he married Elizabeth of York, the eldest daughter and heir of Edward IV, thereby uniting the two claims. The House of Tudor ruled the Kingdom of England until 1603, with the death of Elizabeth I, granddaughter of Henry VII and Elizabeth of York.

Names and Symbols:

The name Wars of the Roses refers to the heraldic badges associated with the two royal houses, the White Rose of York and the Red Rose of Lancaster. Wars of the Roses came into common use in the nineteenth century, after the publication in 1829 of Anne of Geierstein by Sir Walter Scott.[4][5] Scott based the name on a scene in William Shakespeare's play Henry VI Part 1, set in the gardens of the Temple Church, where a number of noblemen and a lawyer pick red or white roses to show their loyalty to the Lancastrian or Yorkist faction respectively.

The Yorkist faction used the symbol of the white rose from early in the conflict, but the Lancastrian red rose was apparently introduced only after the victory of Henry Tudor at the Battle of Bosworth, when it was combined with the Yorkist white rose to form the Tudor rose, which symbolised the union of the two houses;[6] the origins of the Rose as a cognizance itself stem from Edward I's use of a golden rose stalked proper.[7] Often, owing to nobles holding multiple titles, more than one badge was used: Edward IV, for example, used both his Sun in splendour as Earl of March, but also his father's Falcon and Fetterlock as Duke of York. Badges were not always distinct; at the Battle of Barnet, Edward's 'sun' was very similar to the Earl of Oxford's Vere star, which caused fateful confusion.

Most, but not all, of the participants in the wars wore livery badges associated with their immediate lords or patrons under the prevailing system of bastard feudalism; the wearing of livery was by now confined to those in 'continuous employ of a lord', thus excluding, for example, mercenaries.[9] Another example: Henry Tudor's forces at Bosworth fought under the banner of a red dragon,[10] while the Yorkist army used Richard III's personal device of a white boar.

Although the names of the rival houses derive from the cities of York and Lancaster, the corresponding duchies had little to do with these cities. The lands and offices attached to the Duchy of Lancaster were mainly in Gloucestershire, North Wales and Cheshire, while the estates and castles that were part of the Duchy of York were spread throughout England and Wales, although many were in the Welsh Marches.

By,

Clemencia. A

Peace and Literature

Violence and Bloodshed,
Wars in History,
Love and Land,
Wars in Literature.

Helen, brought the war between
Paris and Menalaus,
The Lilliputans fought against
The Laputans.

Wars even happen with words
Poets and Authors fight with pen,
The learned know what hurts more,
Not Bloodshed and violence.

The most difficult war,
Overcoming our own difficulties,
The combat between,
Mind and Heart

Wars must not be imposed,
To hurt,
Words must be spoken,

To Heal.

For Literature tells us,
Healing is better than Killing,

– A. Jaysree, I M.A.English.

War and Its Influence on Literature

My opinion about war:

The first thing that comes to my mind when I hear the word "war" is death of innocent people and brave patriots. War is defined as an act of invasion of nations to their opponents with the use of armed forces and other acts of combat.

My personal definition of war is an act of bravery and heroism of citizens who have a sincere and deep yearning to serve his or her country. My sentiments go to the family of soldiers who give up their lives for their country of origin as well as innocent lives taken away during battles. Regardless of how war is generally interpreted, it makes me realize how short and precious life is, especially when lost in the battlefield. My sentiments go to their families who feel greater sadness of the loss of their loved one.

Literature shaped by war:

Literature in the form of written works is shaped by many influences including war. War is a reality that involves people who are affected by the fighting. People who are affected by tragic loss of lives are the country in general and families. These people can find comfort in literature as it offers an explanation to what is happening or what has happened. The touch of realism as a result of war has greatly shaped literature and other texts.

The art of written works offer a sense of security and meaning to people who are directly or indirectly affected. It gives a view of life that depicts life and suffering. The authors of literature create an accurate depiction of changing life in the minds of people. Some forms of literature takes its form based on war as it combines scientific reasoning, physical examination, and psychological investigation. The portrait of war through literature helps people to adjust to the effects of war by defining its significance so as to enable them to accept the reality as part of the healing process.

Representations of young people's experiences of war:

It compares the constructions of children's and adolescents' experiences of contemporary wars in two genres published for Western audiences: young adult fiction and childhood/young adulthood memoirs. This approach is based on the theoretical assumption of a significant difference between the two genres. I view young adult fiction as a genre regulated by a power imbalance between its adult creators and its young adult consumers - a relationship which predetermines the compliance of representations of adolescence as well as of wars with Western adults' understanding of these phenomena, as well as with the way adults wish adolescents to know about them. Even though involving a similar power imbalance, this time between Western collaborators and non-Western authors who have experienced war in their childhoods, war memoirs belong to a referential genre in a special relationship to reality. Bearing in mind that life writing as a discourse also has its rules and conventions, I explore the potential of the memoirs' genre-defining preferentiality throw into relief the mediation which young adult novels employ in constructing adolescents' war experiences.

Despite the differences between the two genres, they both evoke, and at the same time challenge, the pattern of the rite of passage in order to accommodate contradictory perceptions of young people's war involvement, such as ideas of children's innocence and need of adult protection, but also of children's possession of greater resilience than adults, or children's ability to perpetrate horrific acts of violence; ideas of the devastating physical and psychological impact of war, especially on young people, but also traditional notions of war as a maturing experience, especially its role in the construction of masculinity. I also examine the systematic differences in the employment of the rite of passage between the two genres, based on the different ways they relate to and participate in the extra literary "passages" in which their authors or readers are involved. In the context of young adult fiction, the rite-of-passage framework could be read as a sign of adults' wish to re-establish some degree of control over adolescents' maturation. Young people's war memoirs, on the other hand, could be read as a metaphorical rite of passage for their authors: a passage of overcoming and re-evaluating their war experiences, as well as undergoing a cultural transition from their countries of origin to the Western countries where they have immigrated.

- A.BENITTA CAROLINE,
M.A.ENGLISH.

Natural Disaster

Darkened clouds. Wind and rain.
Left alone with all this pains
Its winter here without you

Landslides always drag me down
Trapped for days will I be found ?
I pray for skies of blue

Flooded plains with in my head
Tornadoes draw near leave me for dead
I feel alone without you

This natural bridge from heart to heart
Collapsed in shreds fallen apart
These seasons last forever.

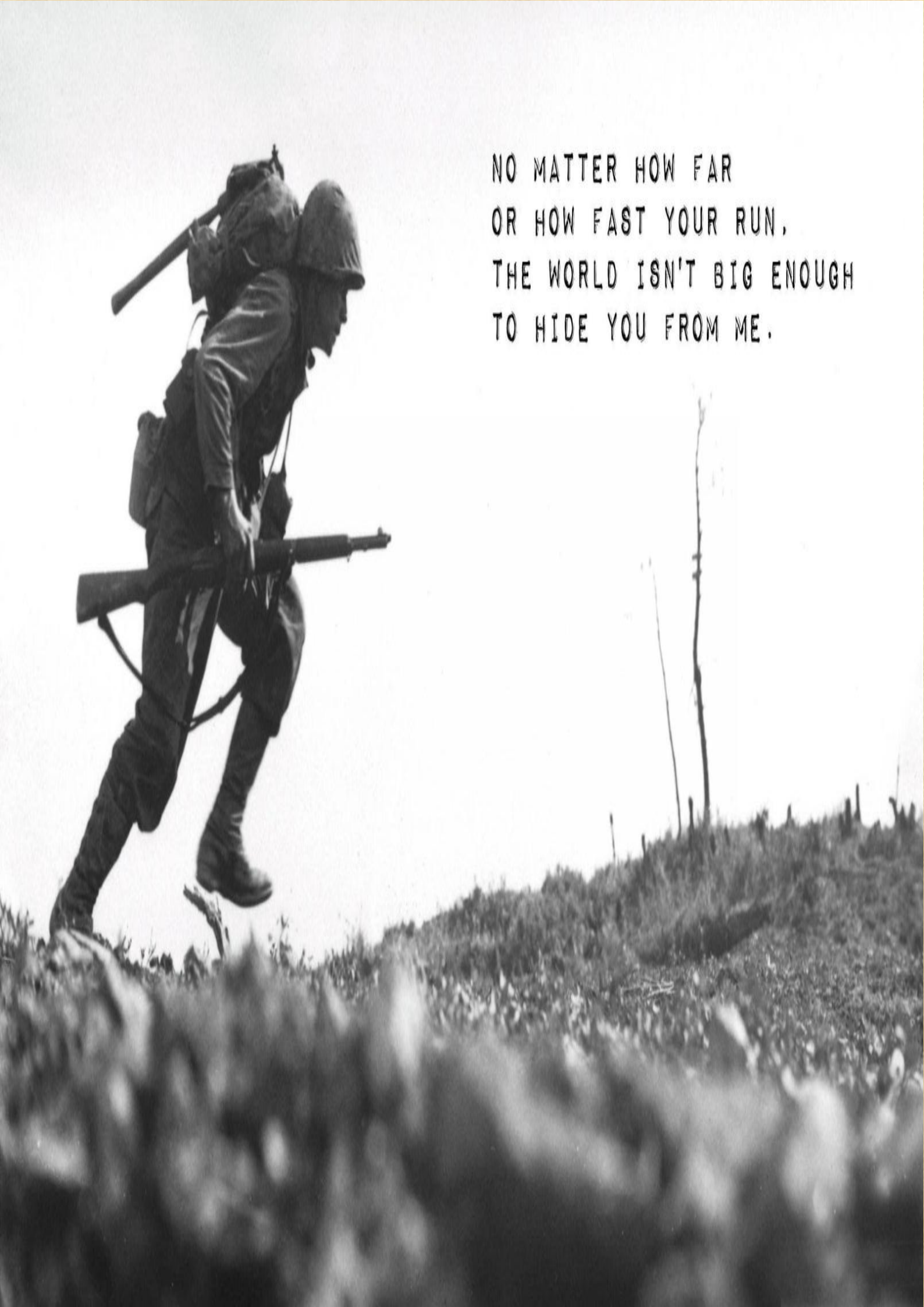
- **By E. Kanimozhi**

Facts about the Black Death

- The Black Death (October 1347 to c1352) did not eradicate a third of Europe's population.
- The Black Death was not a disease of the black rat transmitted to human by fleas.
- The Black Death was not a disease of Poverty.
- The Black Death was not a disease only a large cities and towns and Villages in the lowlands.
- The Black Death did not afflict all major European cities and towns on Principal trade routes.
- The Black Death did not result everywhere in the blaming of other minorities.
- The first 'quarantine' was not inverted in Venice- rather it was a ' trentine ' first legislated in Ragusa.
- All human attempts to end the plague in Europe were not in vain.
- Despite the thousands who sacrificed their lives assisting spiritually or physically the afflicted during the Black Death, the church awarded none of them with blessed or saintly status.
- The Black Death travelled 30 to 100 times faster over land than the Bubonic plagues of the 20th century.

By,

Nithya. K


NO MATTER HOW FAR
OR HOW FAST YOUR RUN,
THE WORLD ISN'T BIG ENOUGH
TO HIDE YOU FROM ME.